

SHOWCASE

LE PAGE SPORTING GUN

Pierre le Page set up in business as a harquebusier in Paris, perhaps as early as 1716, and was later appointed gunmaker to the king. He was succeeded by his nephew Jean in 1782, who was retained by the Emperor Napoleon to refurbish weapons from the royal gun-room for his own use. Jean's son Henri took over the firm in 1822, by which time Napoleon had died in exile. This sporting gun was made to commemorate the return of his ashes to France in 1840.

LE PAGE SPORTING GUN

Date 1840

Origin France

Barrel 31½in (80cm)

Caliber .84in



▼ LE PAGE SPORTING GUN

While the technical quality of the gun is excellent, its appeal lies in its decoration. The scroll-work on the small of the stock is enhanced by steel wire, while the metalwork is engraved with scenes from Napoleon's life and the names of some of his battles.

▼ ACCESSORIES BOX

This is a turned rosewood box intended for storing small accessories such as charge-drawing "worms" and spare percussion nipples. The joint between the lid and the body of the box is hidden in a groove within the decorative turned bands.

◀ BULLET MOLD

A percussion sporting gun could be loaded with pellets, for hunting birds and wildfowl, but also with balls for to hunt large game. This mold was used to make such balls.

► WAD PUNCH

Wadding, usually made of paper, was rammed into the barrels after the powder, but before the bullets, using this punch. Because it was essential that the wads precisely fit the barrels, a wad cutter was included with the gun's tools.

